

Prayers for our World and the Church

including Prayer of Confession

13th September 2026

Ps 60:11-12 [11] *Oh, grant us help against the foe, for vain is the salvation of man!* [12] *With God we shall do valiantly; it is He who will tread down our foes.*

In between two hymns, we come to a time of prayer, to acknowledge God's greatness and to confess our need of Him. We bring our requests to Him Who "does valiantly" as the Psalmist declares, and Who alone is able to bring lasting change, according to His purposes for the world and for us within it.

Adoration

God Almighty, Father, Son and Holy Spirit, Creator of all that is, we Your creatures dare to come before You Who are merciful, faithful and just. From everlasting to everlasting, You alone are God, all-powerful, all-seeing, all-holy and altogether righteous.

Confession

If we were to rely on Your justice, we would be lost, for we are fallen, so sinful in our self-centredness that we would not seek You out. But because You are all-loving, and graciously merciful, we are not destroyed. We look back upon our week and recognise the times when we have failed to honour You, when we have not loved as Jesus demonstrated, but have put ourselves first, when we have given in to temptation. We freely confess our sins to You now.

Thanksgiving

We thank You that You have not abandoned us, but instead You sent Jesus to seek and save the lost. We know that there is no salvation in any man on earth, and we thank You for the special grace of a heavenly salvation. For while we were still sinners, enslaved by a great foe, He came as the Sinless Perfect Son of God and Son of Man to take our place and suffer the penalty which we deserved, dying in our stead so we could go free.

We thank You that You raised Him up on the third day, defeating that foe, and his weapon of death and sin, and beginning the restoration of what was Your perfect creation. We thank You that there will be an end to sin when Jesus returns and institutes the new heaven and the new earth.

Supplication: The Wider World

In the wider world, we continue to pray for the nations where sin still reigns, where Your people are set upon by terrorists and have to flee for their lives, and for our nation where opposition is less obvious but just as powerful.

Here in Victoria, we pray for the many who are discouraged by their situation, and ask for Your guidance in speaking words of hope, as we rely on Your Word for our own encouragement.

... and the wider Church

We pray also for Your people in churches throughout this land. We thank You for all places where Your Word is faithfully preached. We thank You for our College and for the students who will take up their positions at the end of their studies.

Supplication: Ashburton

Here in Ashburton we pray for Alan as he preaches Your Word, and we pray for our own understanding as we listen. Holy Spirit, we pray that You would change us so that we live our lives more and more in conformity to that powerful Word.

Finally, we pray for ourselves in the service of the Kingdom. We thank You that we are a part of the work of spreading the Good News, and members of the world-spanning Body of Christ. May we grow to show the character of our Risen Lord so well that others will see Him rather than us. In Jesus Name we pray, Amen.